SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #43 · SALVATION

“One more sin and God will give up on me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A parent or authority who gave “last chances” and then gave up. Threats that you would lose God’s love if you kept failing. Long struggles with a habit that make you feel God must be running out of patience. Fear-based teaching about falling away. Relationships where one mistake ended everything.

What Scripture teaches

God’s faithfulness does not depend on yours. Even when we are faithless, He remains faithful. He has promised never to leave or forsake His children. When a believer falls, the LORD holds his hand. Nothing in all creation can separate you from God’s love in Christ, and the God who began a good work in you will finish it. Sin is serious, and God may discipline you, but He does not give up on His children.

> *“For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord”* **(Romans 8:38–39)**.

Also see

> “If we are faithless, He remains faithful, for He cannot deny Himself” **(2 Timothy 2:13)**.

> “The steps of a man are ordered by the LORD who takes delight in his journey. Though he falls, he will not be overwhelmed, for the LORD is holding his hand” **(Psalm 37:23–24)**.

> “Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: ‘Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.’” **(Hebrews 13:5)**.

> “Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus” **(Philippians 1:6)**.

Common self-statements

- This is my last chance.
- If I mess up again, God is done with me.
- God’s patience must be almost gone.
- I have to be perfect from now on, or I’m lost.
- God gives up on people like me.
- One more failure and it’s over.

Common logical errors

- **Projection:** Picturing God like people who gave up on you.
- **Catastrophizing:** Treating the next mistake as the end of everything.
- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you are either perfect or rejected.
- **Fortune telling:** Predicting that God will abandon you.

Challenging questions

- What does Romans 8:38–39 say can separate me from God's love?
- If I am faithless, what does God remain?
- Who in my life gave up on me, and am I picturing God like them?
- What does God promise in Hebrews 13:5?
- When a believer falls, who holds his hand?
- Does fear of God giving up make me stronger or more anxious?
- Who promised to finish the work in me?

Truth summary

> God will not give up on me. Nothing in all creation can separate me from His love in Christ. Even when I am faithless, He remains faithful. When I fall, He holds my hand. My sin is serious, and He may correct me, but He will never leave me or forsake me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Love, By God
- Grace
- Salvation
- Backsliding
- Trust

Godly Counsel Chapters:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a chapter to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Sin
- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Backsliding
- Belief/Salvation

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Reckless Love — Cory Asbury
Pictures God as the shepherd who goes after the one who wandered, rather than giving up on them.

Run to the Father — Cody Carnes
Like the prodigal son, we can run back to a Father who is already running toward us.

Come As You Are — Crowder
God's welcome does not wait until we clean ourselves up; we can come to Him as we are.

He Will Hold Me Fast — Keith & Kristyn Getty

Our security rests on Christ holding onto us, not on how tightly we hold onto Him.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "One more sin and God will give up on me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"One more sin and God will give up on me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What can separate me from God's love?
- ☐ If I am faithless, what does God remain?
- ☐ Am I picturing God like someone who gave up on me?
- ☐ What does God promise in Hebrews 13:5?
- ☐ When I fall, who holds my hand?
- ☐ Who promised to finish the work in me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Nothing can separate me from God's love in Christ.
- ☐ Even when I am faithless, He remains faithful.
- ☐ God will never leave me or forsake me.
- ☐ When I fall, the LORD holds my hand.
- ☐ God does not give up on His children.
- ☐ God will finish the work He began in me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Romans 8:38–39**
  "For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord."
- [ ] **2 Timothy 2:13**
  "If we are faithless, He remains faithful, for He cannot deny Himself."
- [ ] **Psalm 37:23–24**
  "The steps of a man are ordered by the LORD who takes delight in his journey. Though he falls, he will not be overwhelmed, for the LORD is holding his hand."
- [ ] **Hebrews 13:5**
  "Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: 'Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.'"
- [ ] **Philippians 1:6**
  "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Listen to one song each day** from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Faithfulness log:** Each day, write one way God has been faithful to me, even when I was not.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Psalm 37:23–24 becomes: "**Sarah's** steps are ordered by the LORD who takes delight in **her** journey. Though **she** falls, **she** will not be overwhelmed, for the LORD is holding **her** hand."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Love, By God" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read Romans 8:31–39 aloud** every morning this week.
- ☐ **After a failure, confess it, then write:** "God has not given up on me," and take one good next step.
- ☐ **Write a list of times you fell and God restored you,** and keep it where you can see it.
- ☐ **Talk with a trusted Christian** about a time they failed and God did not give up on them.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "One more sin and God will give up on me": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One way God stayed faithful
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~One more sin and God will give up on me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that nothing can separate me from Your love in Christ. Help me reject the lie that one more sin will make You give up on me. When I fall, hold my hand and lift me up. Thank You for remaining faithful even when I am faithless. In Jesus' name, Amen.

✦ ✦ ✦

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.